

# Global Launch Legal Strategy Brief — Get Goods Gratis (Free)

△ **DRAFT — NOT LEGAL ADVICE.** An inventor-prepared strategy brief for discussion with counsel: how to structure the legal work for a **multi-country launch through a single lead attorney**, what can be centralized vs. what needs local review, and a phased market plan. It is a **map of how the process is usually structured**, not legal advice — counsel confirms the specifics. Bracketed items **[LIKE THIS]** are decisions for counsel/owner. Prepared 2026-09-13.

## 0. The question this answers

"Can I prepare a global launch — as many countries as possible — working with one attorney, or do I need a different attorney in every country?" **Short answer: one lead attorney, not fifty.** You retain a single lead firm that handles everything centralizable and quarterbacks local specialists only where a specific market requires it. This brief lays out that model and a phased plan so "global" is tractable and affordable.

## 1. The engagement model — hub and spoke

- **One lead firm (the hub).** Your primary counsel coordinates the whole effort, handles all centralizable work (§3), and is your single point of contact.
- **Local counsel (the spokes), engaged as needed.** When a market needs a local specialist (e.g., promotions law, data registration, payments), the **lead firm engages and manages them** — often through its own international network, a formal law-firm alliance, or referral relationships — so you keep one relationship.
- **The decisive question to ask any prospective lead firm:** "Do you have an international network, or can you quarterback local counsel in my target markets?" That one answer tells you whether a firm can serve a global launch. **[Owner: ask this of every firm you interview.]**

## 2. The foundation you already have — "strictest standard, applied worldwide"

The platform is already built to adopt the **strictest** applicable rule and apply it to everyone, rather than geo-detecting the minimum per user (see `STRICTEST-STANDARD-COMPLIANCE-POLICY.md`, `GLOBAL-COMPLIANCE-AND-LOCALIZATION.md`). This is exactly the right posture for going global cheaply: **one compliant product clears many regimes at once**, so most legal work is done once at the framework level and only a thin layer is country-specific. Protecting this posture is the first instruction to give counsel.

## 3. Centralize vs. localize — the split that sizes the work

| Centralizable — done once, covers everywhere (lead firm)                                            | Country-specific — needs local input, market by market                                                              |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Corporate/entity structure and the IP-holding entity                                                | <b>Promotions / sweepstakes law</b> — varies wildly; some countries restrict or ban prize competitions (per-market) |
| The full contract stack: ToS, EULA, Privacy framework, Partner Agreement, Advertiser Agreement, AUP | <b>Consumer-protection</b> specifics (distance selling, cancellation/withdrawal rights, warranties)                 |
| US federal + state law analysis                                                                     | <b>VAT/GST registration</b> and invoicing rules                                                                     |
| <b>Trademark</b> via the <b>Madrid Protocol</b> (one filing → many countries)                       | <b>Data-protection representatives</b> (GDPR Art. 27 EU rep; UK rep) and any local registration                     |
| <b>Patent</b> via the <b>PCT</b> (one international filing preserves rights ~150 countries)         | <b>Payments / e-money / money-transmission licensing</b> (the big per-jurisdiction landmine — §4)                   |
| Privacy framework at the GDPR high-water mark (§6)                                                  | <b>Language/localization</b> of legal terms and consumer disclosures                                                |
| AI-content disclosure / C2PA posture                                                                | <b>Advertising law</b> specifics and any <b>age/gambling-adjacency</b> rules                                        |

The table is the whole point: the **left column is most of the work and it's done once**; the right column is a thin, market-by-market layer you add as you expand.

## 4. The closed-loop design is your licensing firewall — preserve it

**Money-transmission and e-money licensing is the single biggest per-country landmine** for a platform like this. Your **closed-loop, non-cashable** consumer credit (Site Cash) — with real money flowing only to businesses/partners — is

precisely what keeps you out of most of that licensing in most jurisdictions. Every market-entry decision should start by confirming the closed loop holds there. This ties directly to [TREASURY-SOLVENCY-AND-PAYPAL-SETTLEMENT.md](#) and [PAYMENTS-ARCHITECTURE-AND-MERCHANT-BRIEF.md](#). **[Counsel: confirm the closed-loop posture keeps the platform outside money-transmitter/e-money regimes per target market; flag any market where stored-value/prepaid rules still attach.]**

## 5. Globalizing the IP (the two mechanisms that do the heavy lifting)

- **Trademark — Madrid Protocol.** File once (building on a home/base application) and extend protection to any of ~130 member countries by designating them, through one centralized system, instead of separate national filings. **[Counsel: base application + the initial country designations to file.]** See [TRADEMARK-FILING-BRIEF.md](#).
- **Patent — PCT (Patent Cooperation Treaty).** One international application preserves your filing date across ~150 countries and defers the expensive national-phase decisions for up to **30 months** — buying time to see where the product actually gains traction before committing. **[Counsel/patent attorney: file the provisional first (already drafted), then the PCT within the priority year.]** See [PROVISIONAL-PATENT-APPLICATION-DRAFT.md](#).

## 6. Globalizing privacy — GDPR as the high-water mark

Build to **GDPR/UK GDPR** (the strictest mainstream regime) and most others fall below it. Instead of counsel in every country, the specific appointments are: an **EU representative** and a **UK representative** (GDPR/UK GDPR Art. 27) where required, plus a lawful **international-transfer mechanism** (e.g., standard contractual clauses). This rides on the data map you already have ([DATA-COLLECTION-BRIEF-FOR-COUNSEL.md](#)). **[Counsel: confirm representative appointments and transfer mechanism for the launch markets.]**

## 7. Globalizing tax — one framework for the bloc, a specialist for the rest

Tax is a **CPA/international-tax-advisor** job run in parallel with counsel, not a per-country lawyer task. The EU's **VAT OSS/IOSS** lets you register once for cross-border EU digital-sales VAT; **marketplace-facilitator** rules and economic-nexus thresholds are handled market-by-market by the tax advisor. See [TAX-OBLIGATIONS-AND-FILINGS-BRIEF.md](#). **[Owner: engage an international-tax advisor with multi-country reach, e.g., a Big-4 or specialist, alongside the lead law firm.]**

## 8. Phased market plan — launch in tiers, not everywhere at once

Launching in three well-cleared markets beats launching in forty half-cleared ones. Suggested sequence:

- **Tier A — home + low-friction English markets:** United States first, then **Canada, United Kingdom, Australia**. Lowest legal friction, shared language, strong IP systems.
- **Tier B — the EU/EEA as a single bloc:** GDPR + the **European Accessibility Act** + VAT **OSS** cover 27+ countries under one framework and one set of registrations. Add the Art. 27 EU representative.
- **Tier C — targeted expansion:** further markets added as revenue justifies local counsel, prioritized by market size and legal friction.
- **Geo-restrict at launch:** markets where the prize competition, closed-loop credit, data-localization, or unusual promotion/consumer rules create real friction (e.g., China and certain others) — restrict now, revisit later. **[Counsel: confirm the restrict list.]**

### 8b. Phased rollout & IP cost-deferral — launch US-only, keep global rights

You can launch **operations in the US only**, defer the expensive per-country regulatory work, and still lock in **global IP rights now for a fraction of the cost** — because *where you operate* and *where you own the IP* are separate decisions. International IP runs on **priority dates**: the treaties let you claim your date cheaply now and defer the country-by-country spend for years. Geo-restricting the app to the US at launch defers GDPR reps, VAT registration, and per-country consumer law; the priority filings below run in parallel and do **not** require operating in those markets.

**The priority-date ladder (patents — cheap now, expensive only later and only where you choose):**

- **Now:** US **provisional** (drafted) — modest fee + attorney time; stamps the priority date and "patent pending" for 12 months.
- **By month 12:** file the **PCT** — one international application preserves the priority date across ~150+ countries and **defers national-phase filings to 30 months**. Moderate cost, not per-country.
- **By month 30:** choose the national-phase countries (the real cost — translations, local agents, per-country fees) based on where the platform has actually expanded.

## Deadline calendar (hard dates — missing them can forfeit rights; calendar with counsel now):

- **Provisional + 12 months** → PCT (and/or US non-provisional) filing deadline.
- **US trademark filing + 6 months** → Paris Convention window to file abroad and still claim the US date.
- **Priority date + 30 months** → PCT national-phase entry deadline.

**Trademark — Madrid Protocol + the first-to-file hedge.** File the **US trademark now** as the base, then use the **Madrid Protocol** to file once and **add countries later** (subsequent designation) as you expand. The one place "wait" carries real risk: many countries — notably **China** and the EU — are **first-to-file**, where a squatter can register the mark before you arrive. The cheap insurance is to **defensively file early in just the handful of first-to-file markets** you're most likely to enter, even while launching US-only. **[Counsel: identify the first-to-file markets to protect early vs. defer.]**

**The near-free layers:** copyright is automatic in ~180 Berne Convention countries; trade secrets are protected by keeping them secret (NDAs, access controls) — global by nature, no filing. Leaning on trade-secret protection for the sensitive implementation details (per the provisional's §13) is itself a cost lever.

## 9. Per-market triage — ask counsel to sort every target market into three buckets

---

1. **Clear with the baseline** — the strictest-standard build already satisfies it; launch.
2. **Needs local review** — one discrete local-counsel question (usually promotions, payments, or consumer law) before launch.
3. **Geo-restrict for now** — defer until the product and revenue justify the work.

This triage is the single most useful deliverable to request from the lead firm — it converts "as many countries as possible" into a concrete, prioritized, costed list.

## 10. The high-risk surfaces to clear in each market

---

Across jurisdictions, the recurring pressure points for this specific product are: the **prize competition** (sweepstakes/lottery/gambling lines — the most jurisdiction-variable), the **closed-loop credit** (money/e-money lines — §4), the **earn-to-shop / rewards** model (consumer-protection and "is it a financial product" characterization), **data collection** (§6), **age assurance** (18+ beyond self-attestation, especially with the social/voice feature), and **advertising claims** (truth-in-advertising and the no-results-guarantee posture). Each is already documented in the packet; the global question is simply *which markets need a local look at each*.

## 11. How to work with the attorney — the engagement checklist

---

Bring the lead firm your organized packet and ask them to:

1. **Confirm the strictest-standard baseline** holds as the global foundation (§2).
2. **Run the per-market triage** (§9) over your target list — clear / local-review / geo-restrict.
3. **Preserve and pressure-test the closed-loop firewall** per market (§4).
4. **Set up the IP filings** — provisional → PCT for patent; Madrid for trademark (§5).
5. **Handle the privacy appointments** — EU/UK representatives + transfer mechanism (§6).
6. **Coordinate with an international-tax advisor** for VAT OSS + marketplace-facilitator/nexus (§7).
7. **Confirm they can quarterback local counsel** in the Tier A/B markets (§1).
8. **Sequence the rollout** and the geo-restrict list (§8).

## 12. Questions to finalize (for counsel)

---

1. Lead-firm **international network / local-counsel quarterbacking** capacity (§1).
2. **Target-market triage** — clear / local-review / geo-restrict (§9).
3. **Closed-loop firewall** per market — any stored-value/e-money attachment (§4).
4. **IP filing plan + timing** — provisional/PCT and Madrid designations (§5).
5. **Privacy representatives + transfer mechanism** for launch markets (§6).
6. **International tax** engagement + VAT OSS registration (§7).
7. **Prize-competition** legality per market (§10) — the highest-variance item.
8. **Age-assurance** standard per market given the social/voice feature (§10).
9. **Rollout sequence + geo-restrict list** sign-off (§8).
10. Whether to launch US-only first and expand, vs. Tier A simultaneously (§8).

*This is a draft strategy brief, not legal advice, and is not a substitute for engagement with a licensed attorney (and an international-tax advisor). Related: [STRICTEST-STANDARD-COMPLIANCE-POLICY.md](#), [GLOBAL-COMPLIANCE-AND-LOCALIZATION.md](#), [DATA-COLLECTION-BRIEF-FOR-COUNSEL.md](#), [TAX-OBLIGATIONS-AND-FILINGS-BRIEF.md](#), [TRADEMARK-FILING-BRIEF.md](#), [PROVISIONAL-PATENT-APPLICATION-DRAFT.md](#), [TREASURY-SOLVENCY-AND-PAYPAL-SETTLEMENT.md](#), [FOR-YOUR-ATTORNEY.md](#).*